

THE IN-BETWEEN

Make an engawa



You don't need a veranda to keep its idea. An *engawa* is simply a place to sit at the edge of inside — sheltered, but open to the air and the garden. Make one anywhere: a low bench at an open door, a cushion on a balcony threshold, a chair turned to a window thrown wide.

Its value is that it is neither one room nor the other. It is the *ma* between the house and the world — a few square feet that belong to the pause. Keep it clear, keep it simple, and let it be the place you go when the day asks too much. Some of the calmest minutes of a summer are spent exactly on that edge.

"The most valuable seat in a summer house is the one half-outside it."